vii. A dramatic circumstantial upheaval in a person's life _____ (affairs/crisis)

viii. Involving an extremely important decision or result_____ (circumstantial /crucial)

Reading

You know that India is a peninsula surrounded by water on three sides. The poem given below portrays the critical situation faced by people living near the coastline.

H48D74

a. Read the following poem on "Tsunami" by Lily Usher and answer the questions that follow.

You washed away everything I knew
you destroyed all of my original,
antique walls.
you smashed through my humble home,
and left me sitting,
ankles deep,
on the deserted beach.
watching the waves of your destruction
kiss my sandy memories;
I was furious
until I realized how beautiful the view was.

i) Whom is the poet addressing?
ii) What is the tone of the poem?
iii) Why is the beach deserted?
iv) Why was the poet furious?
v) What was beautiful?

DO YOU KNOW?

A tsunami or tidal wave, also known as a seismic sea wave, is a series of waves in a water body caused by the displacement of large volume of water, generally in an ocean or a large lake.

b. The following is an interesting anecdote of a small boy who dares the giant waves with the help of a tribal boy in the Andaman Islands.

DARE THE WAVES

1. First came the earthquake, then the sea retreated, almost to the horizon it seemed. But now it was coming back. The wave was high and square with a snowdrift of white foam at its head. It was the biggest wave that I had ever seen, but not so big that I would run away. I had turned thirteen and was not easily scared. The wave would break on the shore, maybe even strand a few Bluefin in the sharp grass. I could return home with dinner. Mama would wrap the fish in palm leaves, bake it and serve it with rice cooked in coconut oil. I rubbed my stomach and smiled. But then I remembered. Mama would not cook. She had returned to the village with a headache. The earthquake had given her a migraine. Tonight, Papa would cook. The wave rumbled closer. It made a noise like all the creatures of the world rolled up in a ball. The lion's roar, the bull's bellow, even the snake's hiss. How fabulous!

What is a Bluefin?

2. There were more people on the beach. Further down. A group of teenagers were dancing around a radio. One had a foot hooked over the side of his canoe, but it was unlikely that he would actually venture into the sea. The Nicobaric people respect the ocean and its power. Something thumped on the sand behind me. Too loud to be a coconut, too soft for a wild pig. I turned reluctantly, not wishing to miss one second in the life of the fabulous wave.

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